What Is Contemporary Art? ✕

Today's goals
Complete any 3 learning items · 3/3
Watch 2 videos · 2/2
Complete a graded assessment

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?
- ✓ Welcome to the course! Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Preview What Is Contemporary Art? Video • 51 sec
- ✓ Course instructors respond: what is contemporary art? Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Suggestions for making the most of the course Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection Reading • 10 min

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Source It
- ✓ Introduction to Module 2 Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Arthur Jafa, APEX, 2013 Reading • 10 min
- ✓ In the studio with Arthur Jafa | "The place where images overlap is you" Video • 3 min
- ✓ **Three approaches to appropriation** Reading • 10 min

Share It
- ○ How do artists and architects share and circulate images? Reading • 10 min
- ○ Beatriz González on her street posters in Bogotá, 1983 Video • 2 min
- ○ Two interventions in television and architecture Reading • 10 min
- ○ Alfredo Jaar on Lament of the Images, 2002 Video • 1 min
- ○ Dayanita Singh on Museum of Chance, 2013 Video • 3 min

Watch It
- ○ How are images used to watch and classify us? Reading • 10 min
- ○ Surveilling, seeing, scanning Reading • 10 min

Play It
- ○ What do video games and computers have to do with art and design? Reading • 10 min
- ○ Susan Kare on designing the first Mac icons, 1980s Video • 3 min
- ○ JODI on turning desktop order inside out Reading • 10 min
- ○ Serious games and artificial intelligence Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- ○ Memory Check Practice Assignment
- ○ Reflect on Module 2 Learnings Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ Optional Readings & Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

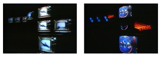
Module 5
Agency

Module 6
Power

Three approaches to appropriation

4:23 / 4:37 1x

Gretchen Bender, *Dumping Core*, 1984



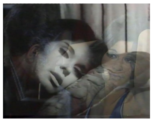
Gretchen Bender. *Dumping Core*. 1984. Electronic theater (four-channel video (color, sound; 13 min.) and thirteen monitors). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. The Modern Women's Fund. © 2019 Gretchen Bender. Courtesy the Estate of Gretchen Bender

Gretchen Bender worked in the commercial sphere on music videos, advertisements, and television shows while simultaneously making art that critiqued the media culture within which she operated. Her work experience made her skeptical of the latest mass communication technologies, including television, which she saw as the next frontier for visual expression and psychological oppression: "I think of the media as a cannibalistic river," she said three years after completing *Dumping Core*. "There is no consciousness or mind. It's about absorbing and converting."

Bender conceived *Dumping Core* as a theatrical presentation complete with live electronic music. It lives on as a gallery installation in which she programmed four videos to play in varying combinations across 13 synchronized monitors. "I'll mimic the media—but I'll turn up the voltage on the currents so high that hopefully it will blast criticality out there," she has explained. The screens pulse with an overload of repeating television graphics, corporate logos, and clips appropriated from advertisements, TV programs, and movies. Bender titled the work after an early computing term, "core dump," which is a recording of a computer's memory captured just before it crashes.

Watch ↗ an excerpt of *Dumping Core*.

Rania Stephan, *The Three Disappearances of Soad Hosni*, 2011



Rania Stephan. Still from *The Three Disappearances of Soad Hosni*. 2011. Video (color, sound), 70 min. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Purchase from the artist. Funds provided by The Fund for the Twenty-First Century

In making a biographical movie about iconic Egyptian actress Soad Hosni, filmmaker Rania Stephan claimed two principal motivations: her ardent admiration for the actress and her desire to revive interest in Egyptian cinema. Hosni starred in 82 films. She worked with every top director during the height of Egyptian filmmaking, from the 1950s to the 1980s, continuing to act until 1991. "I felt that these films belonged to us, we had to reuse them, they are common treasures," said Stephan.

Stephan went to Cairo street stalls to find pirated VHS tapes of Hosni's films and then edited together scenes from the secondhand footage and remixed the soundtracks into an elegiac feature-length film. Its three acts, bookended by a prologue and epilogue, trace Hosni's emergence, maturity, and untimely death, possibly by suicide. Throughout, Stephan blurs the line between Hosni's complex private life and her public personification of an idealized modern Arab woman.

Watch ↗ the trailer for *The Three Disappearances of Soad Hosni*.

Jacolby Satterwhite, *Country Ball 1989–2012*, 2012

Jacolby Satterwhite. Still from *Country Ball 1989–2012*. 2012. Video (color, sound) and video animation ,12:38 min. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Bernard Lumpkin and Carmine Boccuzzi. © 2019 Jacolby Satterwhite

Jacolby Satterwhite draws on sources ranging from art history to voguing to his family's home movies to craft intricate computer animated videos. "I think we're in the age of the remix," he has said. "Now it's just about how you use the information around you to generate your individuality." Satterwhite's training in painting informs what he describes as the "DIY [do-it-yourself] aesthetic" of his videos. For *Country Ball 1989–2012*, he recreated a 1989 home movie of a family cookout, mostly focused on him and his cousins dancing. Clips from the cookout populate the hallucinatory world, which features an ever-shifting landscape based on his tracings of drawings that his mother made of items such as food containers, cakes, a slide, and an imagined record player-boom box. Separately, he filmed himself dancing in 100 different takes, multiplied and altered the images—giving himself long locks of hair or sheathing his face and body in exuberant patterns—and inserted these personas into his animated landscape.

Watch ↗ *Country Ball 1989-2012*.

Go to next item ✓ Completed

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